

Weather

Is it sunny or rainy? Is there snow on the ground or a thunderstorm brewing? People are always interested in the weather because it affects what we do and what we wear.

Kites stay high in the air by catching the wind.



Weather words

Here are some main features of the weather.



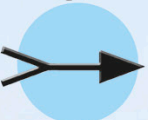
Sunshine gives us heat and light. It warms the air and dries the land.



Clouds are made from tiny water droplets. Dark clouds mean rain is coming.



Hailstones are balls of ice that grow inside thunderclouds.



Wind is air moving around. Winds can be a light breeze or a strong gale.



Rain is drops of water that fall from clouds. Rain is very good for plant life.



Snow is made from tiny bits of ice. It falls instead of rain when it is very cold.



Predicting the weather

Weather forecasters look at pictures beamed back from weather satellites. Computers then help forecasters figure out what the weather is going to be like over the next few days.

Rainy days

Rain clouds form when warm, moist air rises upward and then cools. Droplets of water join together until they become so heavy that they fall. Rain clouds look dark because sunlight cannot shine through the droplets.

